(the meaning of which I knew perfectly well). "And a Happy New Year to you," I said. Would you believe that he got annoyed?

Fred interposed, and the request for revision was reduced to a single point. There were only male characters in the story, and Horace wanted a female.

He was right, in a sense. I was discussing a pioneer society, but surely it contained women. I, on the other hand, was willing to accept them for granted. They were not an essential part of the plot and I feared having to create a romance in a story where, as I saw it, there was no room for one.

Finally, Horace said, "Just put in a woman. Any woman. Then I'll take the story."

That gave me a wicked idea and I promptly agreed. I rewrote the story, and gave one of the characters a rather shrewish and scolding wife. That was not what Horace had in mind ("Oh what a woman!" he muttered), but he stuck to his word and took the story.

And even as I began my revision of "The Martian Way," I also began work on the second edition of Biochemistry and Human Metabolism. This promised to be a perennial job, like painting a huge suspension bridge—as soon as you've finished, you begin all over again because the end at which you began the paint job needs another one by now.

Of course, we did not yet realize that the book was a failure, and if we had, we would have nourished the feeble hope that in revising it we could do away with its weaknesses and make it a success.

J 3

John Blugerman came visiting on June 21. He had been in the Army twice. After he completed dental school, he had to return to the Army, but this time as an officer, and he was stationed in a peaceful Europe, so it wasn't what it might have been.

He had been abroad for fifteen months and we hadn't seen him for a year and a half, but he hadn't changed; he was as slim and as handsome as ever. He saw his nephew, David, for the first time.

I took the opportunity of John's presence to go to New York on the twenty-third, knowing that there would be someone at home to keep Gertrude company and to help with David.